

Vejlstrup Gårde detecting permission report

Holstebrovej 9, Vejlstrup Gårde, 6990 Ulfborg · 7 October 2026 · Mark

Summary

The permission is about 8.5 hectares of near-level farmland at Holstebrovej 9, ringed by roads that were already there in the 1800s. It lies about 350 m south of Ulfborg's 12th-century church and 30 to 130 m north of a cluster of recorded finds at the Vejlstrup road fork. It deserves a systematic search. Expect medieval and later losses; anything older is possible but unproven.

- **Start in the south.** The strip along the southern boundary of matrikel 25d follows an old track and is the closest ground to the fork, where a gold ring, a row of cooking pits, medieval plough ridges and seven recent detector finds are recorded.
- **Then the north field.** Its northern edge lies on a side road shown on the 1842-99 map, and it is the nearest ground to the church.
- **No protected monuments** lie on or beside the three fields. The only record on the boundary is a kilometre stone on Vembvej.
- **The ground is flatter than the old maps suggest.** The whole permission sits at about 10 m above sea level, on a low tongue of dry land between two streams.
- **Two things to settle first:** whether the fields are ploughed or permanent grass, and who else is detecting next door.

Positions in this report were matched by eye from screenshots and are good to about 10 m on the detailed map and 15 to 30 m on the old maps.

The permission

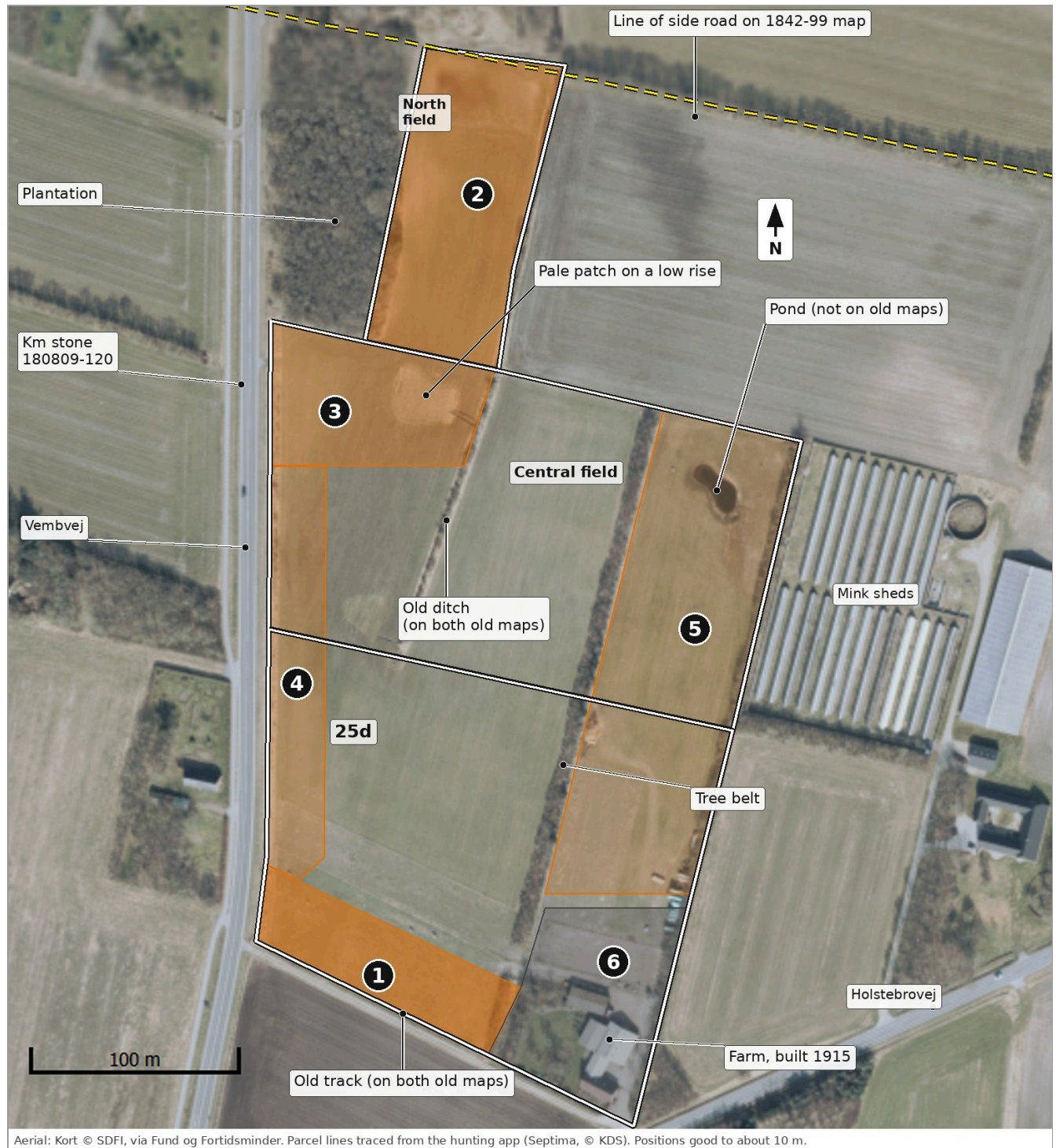
The permission covers three adjoining fields east of Vembvej, as outlined in orange in your hunting app. Together they come to about 8.5 ha.

Field	Size	Shape	Bounded by
North field	about 1.0 ha	strip, 150 m by 65 m	plantation to the west, old ditch to the east, old side-road line to the north
Central field	about 3.7 ha	260 m by 150 m	Vembvej to the west, mink sheds to the east
Matrikel 25d (southern field)	3.78 ha registered	205 m along the track, 150 to 200 m deep	Vembvej to the west, old track to the south; farmhouse and yard in the south-east corner

- **Address:** Holstebrovej 9, Vejlstrup Gårde, 6990 Ulfborg. Ejerslav Den nordlige Del, Ulfborg. Ulfborg parish, Holstebro Kommune.
- **Height:** the farmhouse stands at 9.9 m above sea level, and the fields vary by less than a metre.
- **Land use:** the aerial photo shows grass, divided into four strips by a ditch and a tree belt.
- **Sizes** of the two northern fields are measured from my tracing of the app outline. The same method gives 3.75 ha for 25d against 3.78 ha registered.
- **Matrikel numbers** of the north and central fields are not shown in the app screenshot. You will need them for recording finds.

Maps

The numbered areas run from the first place to search (1) to the last (6); the reasons are in Areas of interest below. White lines are the three fields.



Map 1. Areas of interest, numbered in search order.

The wider setting shows why the southern end leads: the recorded sites cluster at the road fork just south of 25d. Blue dots are records in Fund og Fortidsminder. Yellow dashed lines are roads from the 1842-99 map that no longer exist as roads.

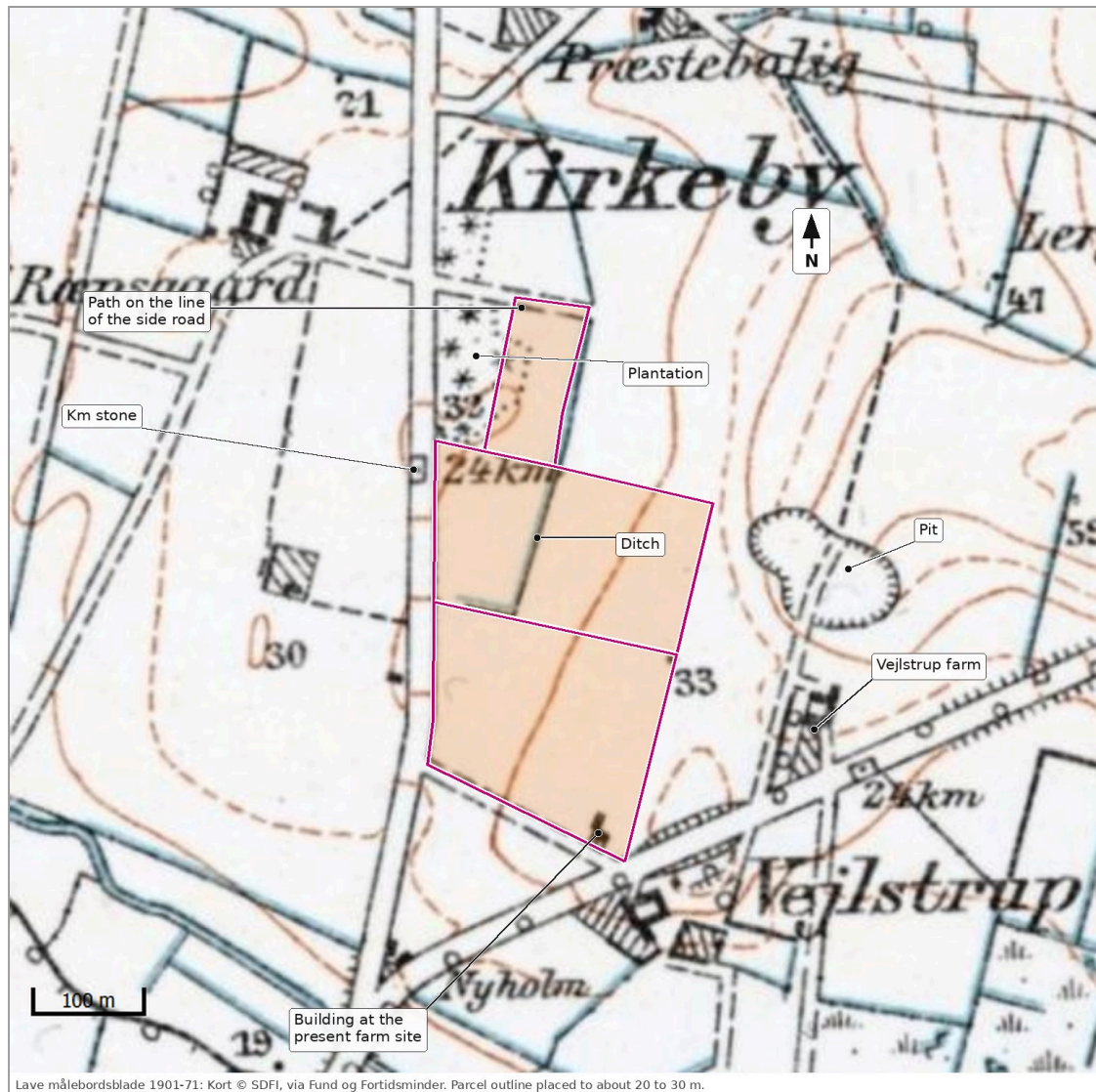
- **The inn.** The 1842-99 map prints 'Veilstrup Kro' at the road fork, and a National Museum survey of 1901 uses the name. The label sits between two groups of buildings. One is in the fork itself, about 150 m from your south-west corner. The other is where the farm south of Holstebrovej stands, about 45 m from your south-east corner. I cannot tell which was the inn. On the 1901-71 map the name has gone and the southern farm is called Nyholm.
- **Roads.** Vembvej and Holstebrovej are both drawn as main roads on the 1842-99 map, on their present lines. Stones marked '24 km' stood on both by the 1901-71 survey. Two lesser roads touch the permission: the track on your southern boundary and a side road along the northern edge of the north field.
- **Your farm.** The 1842-99 map shows no building on 25d. The building register dates the [farmhouse](#) to 1915, and a small building symbol appears at its position on the 1901-71 map.
- **Market.** Ulfborg's royal-privilege market was [first held on 21 August 1840](#). I have not established where it was held at that date.

What the old maps show

Both old maps fit the present fields closely: the north field ends on an old side road, its eastern edge is an old ditch, and the southern edge of 25d is an old track. The field outline is drawn on each sheet below.



Map 3. The 1842-99 map (høje målebordsblade) with the three fields outlined.



Map 4. The 1901-71 map (lave målebordsblade) with the three fields outlined.

- **Side road.** On the 1842-99 map a minor road leaves Vembvej at a crossroads about 90 m west of the north field and runs along the field's northern edge. Its western arm led to Vester Rævsgaard. Its eastern arm survives as the hedge line running east from the field corner. By 1901-71 it is only a dashed path.
- **Southern track.** Both maps show the track on the southern boundary of 25d. It links Vembvej and Holstebrovej and cuts off the fork.
- **Ditch.** Both maps draw the ditch in blue. It forms the eastern edge of the north field and continues through the central field. The line seen on the aerial photo is therefore a drainage ditch at least 125 years old, not a lost road.
- **Low rise.** Both maps draw a small closed contour beside Vembvej at the north-west corner of the central field. The pale patch on the aerial photo lies on its south-eastern edge.
- **Heights.** The 1842-99 sheet gives the rise as 39 Danish feet and the 1901-71 sheet as 32. The later sheet agrees with modern data (the farmhouse at 9.9 m is about 32 feet), so I use it. Your fields are at 32 to 33 feet (about 10 m). The streams to the north and south-west are at 19 to 21 feet (about 6 to 6.5 m). The ground rises to 41 to 59 feet further east.
- **What that means.** The permission sits on a low tongue of dry ground about 3.5 to 4 m above two streams, with the main road running along it. Within the fields the relief is under a metre. A single contour runs north to south near the tree belt, and the ditch follows a slight hollow west of it.

- **Pit.** A sand pit (1842-99) and a larger pit (1901-71) lie about 115 m east of your eastern boundary, under today's milk-farm buildings. This is not your pond. The pond is on neither map, so it was dug later.
- **Plantation.** Tree symbols appear west of the north field on the 1901-71 map only. In the 1800s the north field lay open to the road.

Recorded archaeology

Nothing is recorded inside the three fields, and there are no protected monuments in view. Seven records lie around them; four have been opened.

Record	What it is	Date given	Where
180809-2	Gold ring found by a girl 'at Veilstrup Kro' about 1876 to 1881, reported to the National Museum survey in 1901 and thought to have been sent to the museum (C3426)	Prehistoric, bracketed 1700 BC to AD 375	Fork cluster
180809-93	Crop marks photographed from the air by Holstebro Museum in 2009: a row of four cooking pits about 1 m across, and 14 ridges of ridge-and-furrow ploughing	Pits undated; ridges historic period	Fork cluster
180809-158	Detector finds sent for danefæ assessment: one in 2021, four in 2024, two in 2025 (journal DKM 21.031)	Historic period	Fork cluster
180809-120	Kilometre stone, registered in 2016 during a cycle-path investigation (journal DKM 20.732)	Modern	Vembvej verge at the north-west corner of the central field
Not opened	Three further dots		One in the fork cluster; one 240 m west of your south-west corner; one 205 m east of your eastern boundary

- **Where the fork cluster is.** Two of its four dots are in the triangular field 30 and 50 m south of your southern boundary. The other two are at the fork, 110 and 125 m from your south-west corner. I cannot say which dot belongs to which record.
- **The gold ring** shows a loss or deposit of real value near the stream crossing, but the findspot is only known as 'at the inn'. The museum number begins with C, which is the National Museum's prefix for Iron Age objects if I have the lettering right.
- **The cooking pits** point to prehistoric activity. Rows of such pits are usually Late Bronze Age or early Iron Age. Four pits are not a settlement.
- **The plough ridges** show the ground beside you was ploughland in the medieval or early modern period, which spreads finds thinly through manuring.
- **The detector finds** are the strongest signal. Someone is working the ground next door and has produced seven finds worth sending for assessment in five years.
- **The cycle-path investigation** in 2016 looked at a strip along Vembvej. The kilometre stone is the only record I can see from it on your frontage, which is mild evidence against much lying right at the roadside.

Areas of interest

The southern strip of 25d ranks first because it combines an old track with the shortest distance to real recorded finds. Numbers match the first map.

Rank	Area	Why	How to search
1	Southern strip of 25d: a band about 35 m deep along the track, including the south-west corner	Track on both old maps; 30 to 50 m from two recorded sites; medieval ploughland and the inn next door	Tight lanes parallel to the track, all metals
2	North field, starting at its northern headland	Old side road along the northern edge, with a crossroads 90 m to the west; the nearest ground to the church; open to the road in the 1800s	Small enough to cover completely
3	Low rise and pale patch at the north-west corner of the central field	The only local high spot; a pale oval about 30 m across of unknown origin	Detect, and walk it for flint, sherds and burnt stone
4	Vembvej frontage: a strip about 25 m deep between areas 3 and 1	Main road since at least the 1800s	Expect modern litter; discriminate less than you would like
5	Eastern strips, east of the tree belt, including the pond	Slightly higher ground; nearest to the old Vejlstrop farm, 140 m away	Expect wire and staples near the mink sheds; the pond itself is recent
6	Farmyard and its surroundings	Occupied only since about 1915	Heavy modern junk; low priority, and only where the owner agrees

- **Unranked ground.** The open middle of the central field and of 25d should produce a thin manuring scatter. Sample it with wide lanes before giving it time.
- **The ditch.** The banks may hold finds thrown up when it was dug or cleaned, but the ditch follows a damp hollow and is not a route.
- **Pale patch caution.** If it is a ploughed-out mound, anything left of a burial lies below the plough layer and is not yours to dig. A natural sand rise or an old clamp site is just as likely.
- **Changes from the earlier discussion.** The farm corner has dropped, because the old Vejlstrop buildings turned out to be the neighbouring farm. The north field has risen, because the side road along its edge is now confirmed.

First 10 hours

Spend the first half on the two best areas and the second half finding out how quickly the finds thin out.

1. **Hours 1 to 3: area 1.** Tight lanes about 1.5 m apart, parallel to the track, working north from the boundary. Give the south-west corner extra time.
2. **Hours 3 to 5: area 2.** Start on the northern headland along the old side road, then cover the rest of the north field.
3. **Hours 5 to 6: area 3.** Detect the rise and the pale patch, and walk them with your eyes down for flint, pottery and burnt stone.

4. **Hours 6 to 8: sampling.** Wide lanes about 15 m apart across the central field and the rest of 25d, to map where the density is.
5. **Hours 8 to 9: area 4.** The Vembvej frontage.
6. **Hour 10: go back** to whichever spot gave the most, and tighten the lanes there.

Log every non-ferrous find with a GPS point, including buttons and scrap. The pattern of ordinary finds is what shows where the real ones will be.

What to expect

Post-medieval finds are near certain and medieval finds are likely; everything earlier is a minority chance. The figures are my judgment from the evidence above, not measured rates.

Period	Chance of a datable find	Typical finds
Post-medieval (after 1536)	Near certain	Skilling coins, buttons, lead seals, buckles, thimbles, harness fittings
Medieval (about 1050 to 1536)	Likely	Pennies of the civil-war period, buckles, strap ends, legs from bronze cooking pots
Viking Age and Late Iron Age	15 to 25%	Small brooches, lead weights, cut silver
Earlier Iron Age	10 to 20%	Fibulae; more often iron-smelting slag
Bronze Age	Under 10%	Bronze fragments; watch for worked flint on the surface

Casual loss or settlement? Roads, an inn and manured ploughland give a thin, even spread of single coins, buttons and fittings. A settlement gives a tight cluster, 50 to 100 m across, of mixed household metal: several brooches, lead spindle whorls, weights, casting waste, knife and key fragments, pot legs and slag. Dark soil, fire-cracked stone and pottery in the same spot strengthen the case. Be careful with black potsherds: West Jutland jydepotte ware was made into the 1800s and can look prehistoric.

Rules and reporting

Nothing on these fields is protected, so the working rules are the ordinary ones.

- **Permission.** Keep the landowner's agreement current and follow any conditions on crops, livestock and the yard.
- **Protected monuments.** Detecting is not allowed on a protected monument or within 2 m of it. None is recorded on or beside the permission.
- **Danefæ.** Finds that qualify as danefæ belong to the state and must be handed in. The responsible museum here is De Kulturhistoriske Museer i Holstebro Kommune (Holstebro Museum).
- **Recording.** Register finds in DIME with a GPS point and the matrikel number. The museum will tell you how it wants finds delivered.
- **Depth.** Stay in the plough layer. If finds concentrate, or you meet dark pits, burnt stone, bone, whole pots or several coins together, stop and call the museum.
- **Grass.** If the fields are permanent grass, cut neat plugs and replace them, and expect finds to sit deeper and come up less often than on ploughed land.

Limits and open questions

This is a desk assessment built from your screenshots and a small number of public sources; nothing has been checked on the ground.

- **Old-map readings are mine.** The inn label, the side road, the building symbols and the heights are read from scanned maps that sit 15 to 30 m off the modern photo in places.
- **Record positions are approximate.** The dots are the register's coordinates, and older records can be tens of metres out.
- **Period chances are judgments.** No finds from the permission itself are known to me.
- **Corrections to my earlier messages.** The numbers 24, 37 and 39 are heights, not monuments. The rise is not 2 m above the farm; the fields are near level. The old pit is not your pond. The old Vejlstrup building is the neighbouring farm, not yours. The farm to the north-west is Vester Rævsgaard.

Open questions:

- ☐ Ask the landowner whether the fields are ploughed or permanent grass, and when they are free to search.
- ☐ Ask the landowner whether another detectorist has permission on the neighbouring land.
- ☐ Get the matrikel numbers of the north and central fields.
- ☐ Open the three remaining dots in Fund og Fortidsminder and note type and date.
- ☐ Ask Holstebro Museum what the finds under journal DKM 21.031 were.
- ☐ Check the earliest cadastral map (about 1800 to 1820) for the inn, the side road and any older farm site.
- ☐ Ask the local history archive in Ulfborg where Vejlstrup Kro stood and where the 1840 market was held.

Sources

- [Ulfborg Kirke, Lex \(Danmarks Nationalleksikon\)](#): church history, churchyard and the former isolation of the church.
- [Holstebrovej 9, 6990 Ulfborg, DanskAdresseAPI](#): matrikel 25d, plot area, building year, ground height.
- [Ulfborg Kirkebyvej 27, 6990 Ulfborg, DanskAdresseAPI](#): church position and ground height.
- Fund og Fortidsminder records [180809-2](#), [180809-93](#), [180809-158](#) and [180809-120](#), read from your screenshots.
- Fund og Fortidsminder map screenshots: aerial photo, høje målebordsblade 1842-99 and lave målebordsblade 1901-71 (Kort © SDFI).
- Hunting-app screenshot of the three parcels (Septima, © KDS) and a Google Maps view of the address.
- [Ulfborg, Risskov travel guide](#): date of the first Ulfborg market, from a search result.
- [Ulfborg Church, VisitDenmark](#): building date, from a search result.
- Rules on danefæ, DIME and protected monuments are stated from general Danish practice; see [Vestmuseum's danefæ guidance](#) for a worked example and check Holstebro Museum's own procedure.
- The place-name dating of -strup names and the reading of cooking-pit rows are general archaeological knowledge, not checked against a specific source for this site.